

THE REWRITE STARTER PACK

M K P A R R I S H

THE REWRITE

S T A R T E R P A C K

A short, guided introduction to rewriting the story you were handed.

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The Rewrite Starter Pack

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First edition.

START HERE

You don't have to burn it all down. You just have to pick up the pen.

Most of us are walking around inside a story we never agreed to. It was handed to us — by a family, a job, a hard season — and we mistook it for the truth because we heard it so many times.

This Starter Pack is the on-ramp. Six short exercises, drawn from the same practice I've used with founders, executives, and creators, to help you find the inherited lines, question the source, and write the first honest paragraph of something truer.

Go slowly. Be honest. There are no wrong answers — only more accurate ones. When you're ready for the full process, the complete work waits in *The Reinvention Workbook*.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Three things to keep close as you work:

One — privacy is the point. No one reads these pages but you. Write the version you'd never say out loud. That's where the truth is hiding.

Two — small is allowed. You don't have to overhaul your life by the last page. A single honest sentence is a complete and worthy result.

Three — come back. A rewrite is a practice, not an event. Pencil is encouraged. So is changing your mind.

Exercise 01

THE INHERITED LINE

Write down one sentence about yourself that you did not choose — something you were told, early and often, until it felt like fact. (“I’m not a creative person.” “I’m the responsible one.” “I’m too much.”)

| Whose voice is it, really? Write it in their words first. Then in yours.

Exercise 02

CONSIDER THE SOURCE

Take the line from Exercise 01. Who benefited from you believing it? Be specific. Sometimes the answer is a person; sometimes it's an old version of you that needed the story to stay safe.

| What did believing it protect you from? What did it cost?

Exercise 03

THE EVIDENCE AGAINST

List three moments from your life that quietly contradict the inherited line. Small counts. The time you did the brave thing. The time you were, in fact, exactly enough.

| If these are true — and they are — what does that make the original line?

Exercise 04

NAME IT PLAINLY

In one honest sentence, write the truer version. Not aspirational. Not a affirmation you don't believe yet. Just the most accurate thing you can stand behind today.

Read it out loud, in your own voice. Notice what your body does.

Exercise 05

THE ROOM YOU WAIT OUTSIDE OF

Describe a room — literal or figurative — you've been waiting for permission to enter. The role. The relationship. The version of your work you keep almost starting.

| What would you do first if you simply decided you belonged in it?

Exercise 06

WRITE YOURSELF IN

Write a short paragraph in the present tense, as the person who already lives in that room. Not “I want to.” “I do.” Make it specific enough to be a little uncomfortable.

This is the first paragraph of the rewrite. Date it. You'll want to remember when you began.

Exercise 07

THE VOICE YOU'D USE

Read your paragraph from Exercise 06 out loud. Does it sound like you — or like someone performing a more impressive person? Cross out every word that isn't yours. Rewrite it in the voice you actually speak in.

| The rewrite isn't about sounding new. It's about finally sounding true.

Exercise 08

ONE SMALL PROOF

Choose one concrete action — small, doable this week — that a person living the new line would take. Not the whole reinvention. One honest step that makes the rewrite real in the world.

Write it as a commitment with a date. Then keep it. Proof beats intention every time.

KEEP GOING

You just did the bravest part — you looked. The rewrite isn't a single sitting; it's a practice. Come back to these pages. Cross things out. Write truer lines on top of them.

You are the author. You always have been.

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